

Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover (Empathy Map Canvas)

Project: Freelancer Web Application (MERN Stack)

Date	10 April 2026
Team ID	Your Team ID
Project Name	Freelancer Web Application (MERN)
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Introduction to Empathy Map

An empathy map is a visual tool used to understand users by analyzing their behaviors, thoughts, feelings, and challenges. It helps teams step into the user's perspective and design solutions that truly address their needs.

In the Freelancer Web Application project, the empathy map is created to understand both freelancers and clients. This ensures that the platform is user-centric and solves real-world problems effectively.

Importance of Empathy Mapping

- Helps understand user behavior and mindset
- Identifies pain points and expectations
- Improves user experience design
- Supports better decision-making in development
- Ensures the product solves real problems

Target User: Freelancer (Student/Beginner Developer)

Think & Feel

Freelancers often think about earning money online and building a career. They feel excited about opportunities but also worried about competition and fake clients. They want recognition for their skills and a platform where they can grow professionally.

See

They see many freelancing platforms like Fiverr and Upwork, where competition is very high. They also observe complex user interfaces and difficulty in getting noticed among experienced freelancers.

Hear

Freelancers hear advice from peers, online tutorials, and social media about freelancing. They often hear that freelancing is difficult at the beginning and requires patience and persistence.

Say & Do

Freelancers actively apply for jobs, create portfolios, and learn new skills. They use platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn to showcase their work and improve visibility.

Pain

• No response from clients after applying • Fake job postings and scams • Payment insecurity • High competition and low visibility

Gain

• Easy access to genuine job opportunities • Secure and timely payments • Recognition based on skills • User-friendly platform with fair opportunities

Target User: Client (Business Owner/Startup)

Think & Feel

Clients think about completing their projects efficiently and within budget. They feel concerned about hiring the right freelancer and ensuring quality work.

See

Clients see many freelancers with similar profiles, making it difficult to choose the best one. They also notice inconsistent quality and lack of trust in some platforms.

Hear

They hear feedback from other clients about bad experiences, delays, and communication issues with freelancers.

Say & Do

Clients post jobs, review proposals, and communicate with freelancers. They compare multiple candidates before making a decision.

Pain

• Difficulty in verifying freelancer skills • Delays in project completion • Communication gaps • Risk of poor-quality work

Gain

• Easy hiring of skilled freelancers • Transparent profiles and ratings • Reliable communication system • Quality work within deadlines

Conclusion

The empathy map provides deep insights into the needs, challenges, and expectations of both freelancers and clients. These insights will guide the design and development of the Freelancer Web Application to ensure it delivers a user-friendly, secure, and efficient platform.